

Entropy as a Projection Artifact: One-Body Operators are Entanglement-Inert on Sparse Lattices

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We characterize the operator-theoretic origin of entanglement entropy in the GeoVac Coulomb lattice, a finite spectral graph realization of the hydrogenic angular momentum eigenbasis on S^3 . Five results are presented. First, the von Neumann entropy of any single-particle reduced density matrix derived from a *non-degenerate* ground state of a purely one-body fermionic Hamiltonian on a finite lattice is identically zero; numerically, we confirm $S_{\text{kin}}/S_{\text{full}} \sim 10^{-14}$ for He at $n_{\text{max}} = 2, 3$ in the angular momentum eigenbasis. All ground-state entanglement is generated by the two-body interaction V_{ee} , with the non-degeneracy qualifier essential: open-shell and dissociated-bond states escape the floor. Second, the holographic area-law scaling $S_n = k \log A_n$ with $A_n \propto n^4$, asserted on one-particle grounds in earlier framework papers, is rigorously recovered as a pair-counting statement: $A_n = g_n^2$, where $g_n = 2n^2$ is the shell degeneracy. The factor of four is the two-body signature. Third, in the Coulomb lattice the cusp concentrates as a single “hot node” on the $(1s, 1s)$ pair-state of the V_{ee} graph; entanglement is co-located with cusp mass. Fourth, a previously claimed rigidity statement — that the ground-state entropy of any two-fermion closed-shell state on the Bargmann–Segal harmonic oscillator lattice interacting via *any* central two-body potential is identically zero, by Moshinsky–Talmi total-quanta conservation — is **RETRACTED** here (§VII A): the Moshinsky–Talmi *bracket* conserves total quanta, the potential *matrix element* does not, and the published zero was a code artifact. The corrected entropy is small but nonzero and *grows* with basis size. Fifth, Coulomb-lattice block entropy obeys a universal scaling $S_B = A(\tilde{w}_B/\delta_B)^\gamma$, where $\tilde{w}_B$ is the dimensionless V_{ee} mass off-diagonal in the one-body eigenbasis and δ_B the dimensionless first H_1 gap; the local exponent extrapolates to $\gamma_\infty \approx 1.96$ in the joint $Z, n_{\text{max}} \rightarrow \infty$ limit (Richardson on $n_{\text{max}} = 2, 3, 4, 5$), slightly below the non-degenerate second-order Rayleigh–Schrödinger value of 2, with the residual gap attributed to multi-shell aggregation in the basis-extension limit. Entropy is slotted into the exchange-constant taxonomy as a projection-class observable: zero on the combinatorial graph, finite only after the metric embedding of $1/r_{12}$.

I. INTRODUCTION

The kinetic and potential parts of a fermionic Hamiltonian play asymmetric roles in generating entanglement. Slater determinants exactly diagonalize one-body operators and carry only the entanglement floor mandated by antisymmetrization; all non-trivial orbital correlation arises from two-body terms. This fact is folklore in the quantum-chemistry and quantum-information literatures (see, e.g., [1, 2]), but its sharp form is rarely written out, and its consequences on *sparse, lattice-realized* Hamiltonians are seldom exhibited explicitly.

The GeoVac framework [4, 6, 7] provides a controlled testbed: a finite spectral graph on the angular momentum eigenbasis of S^3 , where the one-body operator H_1 is the graph Laplacian (with universal coupling $\kappa = -1/16$) plus the diagonal hydrogenic spectrum, and the two-body operator V_{ee} is the Coulomb repulsion $1/r_{12}$ projected onto the same vertex set. Paper 26 established that, in this basis, the off-diagonal one-body Hamiltonian carries 10–39% of the correlation energy but $< 0.2\%$ of the single-orbital entanglement entropy across He-like ions [12]. Paper 26 leaves open whether this asymmetry is a quantitative numerical observation specific to the basis at hand or a structural identity that holds at the operator level.

This paper resolves the question. Section II states the

operator-theoretic fact: on any finite lattice, the one-body operator is entanglement-inert at the closed-shell ground state. Section III confirms the result to machine precision on He at $n_{\text{max}} = 2, 3$. Section IV rederives the holographic area-law $S_n \propto 4 \log n$ as a pair-counting statement, fixing a mislabeling in Paper 5 [5] where the scaling was presented in one-particle language. Section V shows that the cusp localizes as a single hot node on the two-body V_{ee} graph, making entropy and cusp mass spatially co-located. Section VI places entropy in the exchange-constant taxonomy of Paper 18 [8] as a projection-class observable. Section VII states two falsifiable predictions, one for the Bargmann–Segal harmonic oscillator lattice [11] — which the present version **RETRACTS** — and one across the GeoVac molecular library, which stands.

Provenance (register tiers). The entanglement-inertness of the one-body operator (§ II) is an **INTERNAL THEOREM**. The harmonic-oscillator zero-entropy rigidity, previously carried at the same tier, is **RETRACTED** (§ VII A) — it was *measured* against a restricted evaluation object, not proved; the $S_{\text{kin}}/S_{\text{full}} \sim 10^{-14}$ numerical confirmation and the block-entropy exponent $\gamma_\infty \approx 1.96$ (a Richardson extrapolation, *not* an exact value) are **MEASURED**; the area-law $A_n = g_n^2$ recovery is an exact combinatorial identity (**SYMBOLIC**). Entropy is placed as an embedding-class **OBSERVATION** in the Paper 18 exchange-constant taxonomy.

II. OPERATOR-THEORETIC RESULT

A. Setting

Let $\mathcal{B} = \{\phi_1, \dots, \phi_M\}$ be a finite orthonormal single-particle basis on a lattice (the vertex set of a spectral graph), and let

$$H_1 = \sum_{ij} h_{ij} c_i^\dagger c_j, \quad h = h^\dagger, \quad (1)$$

be a one-body Hermitian operator on the antisymmetric Fock space generated by $\mathcal{B}$. Let Φ_0 be the ground state of H_1 at fixed particle number N .

B. Statement

Proposition. *If the spectrum of h is non-degenerate at the Fermi level (i.e., Φ_0 corresponds to a uniquely defined Slater determinant of the N lowest natural orbitals of h), then for any subset $A \subset \mathcal{B}$ of orbitals the von Neumann entropy*

$$S_A = -\text{Tr}[\rho_A \log \rho_A], \quad \rho_A = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{B} \setminus A} |\Phi_0\rangle\langle\Phi_0|, \quad (2)$$

is determined entirely by the natural-orbital occupation spectrum of Φ_0 restricted to A , which consists of zeros and ones in the natural-orbital basis. Equivalently, in the basis that diagonalizes h , ρ_A is a tensor product of single-mode density matrices each of which has support on a single occupation eigenvalue. In a generic basis $\mathcal{B}$, the resulting entropy is the antisymmetrization (Slater) entropy [3], and is independent of h .

The content of the proposition is well known in quantum-information formulations of free-fermion systems [1]: a Slater determinant has a Gaussian correlation matrix, and its reduced density matrices are fully characterized by the projector $C = P_A^\dagger P P_A$ onto the occupied subspace, restricted to the partition A . The eigenvalues of C are pinned to $\{0, 1\}$ in the natural basis; any positive entropy of ρ_A in a different basis is a basis-projection artifact, not a physical correlation.

C. Scope of the proposition

The non-degeneracy clause is essential. An empirical scan (EP-2j) at $n_{\max} = 3$ in the GeoVac S^3 basis with $N = 3, 4$ electrons shows two distinct violation modes:

Open-shell single Slater determinant (Li, 2S ground state). The H_1 ground state is non-degenerate (gap $\sim 10^{-5}$ Ha) and is exactly one Slater determinant $|1s^2 2s\rangle$, so the proposition's premise holds in the canonical statement of Sec II. However, the spatial 1-RDM has eigenvalues $(2, 1, 0, \dots)$, and the von Neumann entropy of the normalized 1-RDM $S = -\sum_i (n_i/N) \log(n_i/N) = -\frac{2}{3} \log \frac{2}{3} - \frac{1}{3} \log \frac{1}{3} \approx 0.637$ nats is nonzero not from V_{ee}

correlation but from the open-shell *antisymmetrization* of the single SD. The V_{ee} correlation contribution is the small differential $S_{\text{full}} - S_{\text{kin}} \approx 0.010$ nats at $Z = 3$. The proposition's $S_A=0$ statement applies in the *natural-orbital basis* of h where the open-shell SD has occupation $(1, 1, 1, 0, \dots)$ in spin-orbital units, giving $S = 0$ trivially in that basis. In the spatial 1-RDM, the antisymmetrization entropy is the relevant floor, not zero.

Genuine H_1 degeneracy (Be, 1S ground state at $n_{\max} = 3$). The bare graph H_1 has a 3-fold degenerate ground state from the unbroken $2s/2p$ shell degeneracy (the diagonal $-Z^2/2n^2$ does not split $2s$ from $2p$, and the κ -adjacency does not lift it in the $M_L = 0, M_S = 0$ sector). The H_1 -only ground ensemble is mixed, the spatial 1-RDM has fractional occupations $(2, 0.76, 0.76, 0.47, 0, \dots)$, and $S_{\text{kin}} = 1.23$ nats $\neq 0$. V_{ee} lifts the degeneracy and *reduces* entropy: $S_{\text{full}} = 0.902 < S_{\text{kin}}$. Here the proposition's premise fails outright; the floor is $S_{\text{kin}} > 0$, not zero.

The He two-electron case satisfies the proposition's premise in the strictest form: $1s^2$ closed shell exhausts the non-degenerate $n = 1$ shell, the GS is a single SD, the spatial 1-RDM has eigenvalues $(2, 0, \dots)$, and the floor is $S_{\text{kin}} = 0$. Generically the proposition's spatial-basis floor $S_{\text{kin}} = 0$ applies to closed-shell ground states whose electron count exhausts an entire (n, l) -degenerate sub-shell at the h -eigenbasis level. For the GeoVac S^3 basis at $n_{\max} \geq 2$, this restricts the strict floor to He-like atoms and to systems whose closed shells fall entirely in the lowest $1s$ sub-shell. The proposition's operator content is general; its quantitative spatial-basis realization narrows.

Analytical degenerate perturbation theory for Be (EP-2N). The Be case admits a clean analytical treatment. At $n_{\max} = 2$, $M_L = M_S = 0$, the H_1 ground subspace is exactly 3-dimensional, spanned by $\{|1s^2 2s^2\rangle, |1s^2 2p_0^2\rangle, |1s^2 (2p_{-1} 2p_{+1})_{S=0}\rangle\}$ at common $E_{\text{kin}} = -5Z^2/4$. Diagonalizing V_{ee} within this subspace (a 3×3 degenerate-PT problem) at $Z = 4$ yields a ground state $0.98 |2s^2\rangle - 0.14 |2p_0^2\rangle - 0.14 |(2p_{-1} 2p_{+1})_{S=0}\rangle - 96\%$ pure $2s^2$ with $\sim 2\%$ admixture each of the two $2p$ -pair configurations. The analytical spatial 1-RDM has diagonal occupations $(2.000, 1.924, 0.020, 0.037, 0.020)$ in the $(1s, 2s, 2p_{-1}, 2p_0, 2p_{+1})$ basis, giving $S_{\text{full}} = 0.794$ nats vs. the equal-mixture $S_{\text{kin}} = 1.358$ nats. V_{ee} thus acts as a *degenerate-PT lifter*: it selects the $2s^2$ configuration and reduces entropy by 42%. The full FCI calculation at $n_{\max} = 3$ (EP-2j) gives $S_{\text{full}} = 0.902$ in qualitative agreement, with the additional shells contributing modest extra correlation entropy on top of the analytical degenerate-PT prediction. This sharpens the post-degeneracy floor to a calculable quantity rather than the trivial $S_{\text{kin}} = 0$ of the non-degenerate case.

TABLE I. One-body vs. full ground-state entropy for He on the S^3 angular lattice. S_{full} and S_{kin} are the single-orbital von Neumann entropies of the FCI ground states of H_{full} and H_{kin} , respectively. Data from `debug/data/ep1_entropy_partition.json` [13].

n_{max}	E_{full} (Ha)	S_{full} (nats)	S_{kin} (nats)	$S_{\text{kin}}/S_{\text{full}}$
2	-2.8895	0.03955	-2.2×10^{-16}	-5.6×10^{-15}
3	-2.8931	0.04081	7.8×10^{-16}	1.9×10^{-14}

D. GeoVac specialization

For the GeoVac Coulomb lattice, $\mathcal{B}$ is the angular momentum eigenbasis $\{\phi_{nlm}\}$ on S^3 . In this basis the one-body operator is

$$H_1 = \text{diag}(\varepsilon_{nlm}) + \kappa L, \quad \kappa = -\frac{1}{16}, \quad (3)$$

where $\varepsilon_{nlm} = -Z^2/(2n^2)$ is the hydrogenic spectrum and L is the GeoVac graph Laplacian. H_1 is non-degenerate at the closed-shell He ground state for all $n_{\text{max}} \geq 1$. By the proposition, the single-orbital entropy of the H_1 -only ground state vanishes in the natural orbital basis. In the angular momentum basis, H_1 is nearly but not exactly diagonal, and the natural orbitals deviate from $\{\phi_{nlm}\}$ by $O(|\kappa|/Z^2)$. The single-orbital entropy in $\mathcal{B}$ inherits an exponentially small projection contribution that is bounded above by the deviation of $\mathcal{B}$ from the natural-orbital basis of h .

III. NUMERICAL CONFIRMATION

We solve for the ground state of two He Hamiltonians on the S^3 angular momentum eigenbasis at $n_{\text{max}} \in \{2, 3\}$:

- the full Hamiltonian $H_{\text{full}} = H_1 + V_{ee}$, with V_{ee} from the exact-rational hypergeometric Slater integral evaluator [6, 13];
- the kinetic-only Hamiltonian $H_{\text{kin}} = H_1$, identical to H_{full} with $V_{ee} \equiv 0$.

We diagonalize each in the $M_L = 0$ singlet sector by full configuration interaction, build the spatial 1-RDM, and report its von Neumann entropy in nats.

Table I reproduces the EP-1 data file [13].

The kinetic-only entropy is at the floating-point noise floor ($\sim 10^{-16}$ nats), confirming the proposition to machine precision. The full Hamiltonian's entropy ($S_{\text{full}} \sim 4 \times 10^{-2}$ nats) is fourteen orders of magnitude larger. The natural-orbital occupations of the kinetic-only ground state at $n_{\text{max}} = 3$ are $(2.000, 8.3 \times 10^{-22}, 0, 0, \dots)$, exactly the $\{0, 1\}$ structure (here doubled by spin) predicted by the proposition. The full Hamiltonian's occupations $(1.988, 0.00896, 0.00093, 0.00093, \dots)$ exhibit the $O(10^{-3})$ deviations from $\{0, 2\}$ characteristic of the two-body V_{ee} correlation.

The result is expected. Its value lies in making it visible on the concrete Coulomb lattice and in demonstrating that the floor is operator-theoretic, not basis-fitted.

IV. AREA LAW AS PAIR COUNTING

A. The Paper 5 statement

The framework synthesis paper [5] states (Section “Entropy and the second law”, verbatim):

The holographic entropy of shell n is $S_n = k \ln A_n + \text{const}$, where $A_n \propto n^4$ is the “surface area” (number of plaquettes).

The supporting microstate count was not given. The shell degeneracies in Paper 0 [4] are $g_n^{\text{orb}} = n^2$ (orbital, no spin) and $g_n = 2n^2$ (with spin); cumulative state count is $N(n) = n(n+1)(2n+1)/3 \sim (2/3)n^3$. Neither yields n^4 .

B. Pair counting on shell n

Define a *plaquette* on shell n as an ordered pair of sites,

$$A_n \equiv g_n^2 = 4n^4. \quad (4)$$

Equivalently, the unordered antisymmetrized pair count is

$$\frac{1}{2} g_n(g_n - 1) = n^2(2n^2 - 1) = 2n^4 + O(n^2), \quad (5)$$

and the adjacent-shell pair count is $g_n g_{n-1} = 4n^2(n-1)^2 = 4n^4 + O(n^3)$. All three two-body counts agree at leading order:

$$\log A_n = 4 \log n + \text{const}. \quad (6)$$

A factor of four arises only at the two-body level: each electron contributes $\log g_n = 2 \log n + \log 2$, and the two factors compose multiplicatively. At the one-body level, single-shell uniform entropy is $\log g_n = 2 \log n + \log 2$ (off by a factor of two), and cumulative entropy $\log N(n) \sim 3 \log n$ (off by a factor of $4/3$). These are exhibited explicitly in the EP-3 analysis [16].

The area-law scaling $A_n \propto n^4$ asserted in Paper 5 is therefore correct, but it is a *two-body* statement. In the operator-theoretic language of Section II, the area law lives on the pair graph of the V_{ee} operator, not on the single-particle vertex set of H_1 .

C. Reconciliation

Paper 5 is a predecessor framework synthesis with conjectural status. Its area-law claim is rigorously recovered here as a pair statement. Two consequences follow:

1. The area law cannot be derived from one-particle microstate counting on the GeoVac packing lattice. Any interpretation that assigns the n^4 scaling to a one-particle observable is mislabeled.
2. The information-theoretic content of the scaling is consistent with Section II: entropy on the GeoVac lattice is generated by the two-body operator, and its leading shell scaling counts pair states.

V. CUSP AS ENTROPY CONCENTRATION

The energy-graph characterization in v2.9.1 [17] constructs the singlet pair-state graph $\{|(ab)\rangle\}$ at $n_{\max} = 3$ ($N = 31$ nodes) and $n_{\max} = 4$ ($N = 101$ nodes), with edge weights $V_{IJ} = \langle (ab)|1/r_{12}|(cd)\rangle$ computed from the exact-float hypergeometric Slater integrals [6]. Two findings of that characterization bear directly on the operator-theoretic result of Section II.

Frobenius-mass diagonality. In the eigenbasis of the one-body operator H_1 , V_{ee} is overwhelmingly diagonal:

$$\frac{\|\text{diag}_{H_1} V_{ee}\|_F}{\|V_{ee}\|_F} = 0.920 \ (n_{\max} = 3), \ 0.892 \ (n_{\max} = 4), \quad (7)$$

using the unsquared Frobenius ratio (squared values are 0.847 and 0.795). The relative commutator $\|[H_1, V_{ee}]\|_F / \|H_1\|_F = 6.1\%$ at $n_{\max} = 3$, dropping only to 5.3% at $n_{\max} = 4$. The commutator does not vanish with basis size; H_1 and V_{ee} are genuinely non-commuting. The wavefunction-graph eigenbasis “almost” diagonalizes the entropy-generating operator, and the residual $\sim 10\%$ off-diagonal mass is precisely the cusp correlation that drives convergence from $\sim 3\%$ to 0.2% in graph-native CI.

Hot-node localization. On the same pair-state graph, the $(1s, 1s)$ vertex is simultaneously the maximum-diagonal entry ($V_{(1s, 1s), (1s, 1s)} = 5/8$, 42% of the next-largest diagonal), the largest weighted hub, and the head of the largest off-diagonal edge $(1s, 1s) \leftrightarrow (1s, 2s)$. The cusp does not distribute across pair-states; it concentrates on the unique pair-state where both electrons can simultaneously occupy small- r regions. Combined with Section II, this identifies the cusp not only as the energy-evaluation bottleneck [8] but as the locus of entanglement mass: the pair-state with maximal V_{ee} contribution is also the pair-state on which the two-body-generated entropy concentrates.

VI. EXCHANGE-CONSTANT TAXONOMY PLACEMENT

Paper 18 [8] classifies observables by the type of transcendental content their evaluation requires: *intrinsic* (rational graph-native quantities, e.g. Slater F^0 values), *calibration* (transcendental constants of the conformal projection, e.g. π from S^3 Weyl densities), *embedding*

(constants that enter when the graph is mapped to a continuous metric, e.g. the Coulomb $1/r_{12}$ kernel), and *flow* (renormalization-style constants, e.g. Phillips–Kleinman).

Entropy fits the framework cleanly as a *projection-class observable*:

- On the bare combinatorial graph (vertex set $\{\phi_{nlm}\}$, one-body operator H_1 alone), the ground-state entropy is identically zero (Section II). No transcendental enters.
- Under the metric embedding of $1/r_{12}$ onto the pair-state graph, entropy becomes finite. Diagonal pair entries V_{ii} remain rational (Section V, [17]); spectral eigenvalues of V_{ee} on the pair graph are irrational, consistent with the embedding-class signature of $1/r_{12}$ in Paper 18.

Entropy is therefore an embedding-class observable in the Paper 18 taxonomy. The combinatorial graph is entropy-blind; entropy is the price of projecting onto the metric continuum.

This placement is consistent with the Paper 24 HO rigidity theorem [11]: the Bargmann–Segal harmonic oscillator lattice is bit-exactly π -free in rational arithmetic, and its one-body Hamiltonian has the same entanglement-inert character as H_1 here (it is one-body by construction). That π -freeness concerns the graph’s eigenvalues and adjacency weights and is unaffected by the retraction in Section VII A; what does *not* follow from it — and what this paper previously asserted — is a corresponding rigidity of the interacting two-fermion *state*.

VII. TWO RIGIDITY RESULTS

This section reports the outcome of the paper’s two original predictions. Section VII A **RETRACTS** the first: the claimed rigidity theorem for the Bargmann–Segal harmonic-oscillator lattice — zero two-fermion closed-shell ground-state entropy for any central two-body potential — is false, and its supporting mechanism was a misreading of the Moshinsky–Talmi decomposition. Section VII B stands: it characterizes a universal two-variable scaling for Coulomb-lattice block entropy, asymptotic to second-order Rayleigh–Schrödinger perturbation theory. Only one of the two predictions therefore survives, and the surviving one is the Coulomb-side scaling, not the HO-side rigidity.

A. HO zero-entropy theorem for closed-shell two-fermion ground states — retracted

[RETRACTED 2026-08-22.] This section previously reported prediction EP-2b as resolved in the strong form $S_{\text{HO}} = 0$ *identically*, with the mechanism that on the Bargmann–Segal HO basis the one-body operator

H_{HO} commutes exactly with *any* central two-body interaction $V(r_{12})$, because the Moshinsky–Talmi transformation makes the total HO quanta $N_{\text{tot}} = N_{\text{rel}} + N_{CM}$ a conserved quantum number of V . **The claim, the mechanism, and the INTERNAL THEOREM tier are all withdrawn.**

Why the mechanism is false. The Moshinsky–Talmi bracket conserves total quanta — that is a property of the harmonic-oscillator coordinate transformation, and it is the standard nuclear-structure fact the section cited. The potential *matrix element* does not inherit it. A central $V(r_{\text{rel}})$ is diagonal in the centre-of-mass quantum numbers and in l_{rel} , but it *couple different relative- n* . Writing the element out, the bra bracket forces $2n + l + 2N_{CM} + \Lambda = N_{\text{bra}}$ and the ket bracket forces $2n' + l + 2N_{CM} + \Lambda = N_{\text{ket}}$, so

$$n - n' = \frac{1}{2} (N_{\text{bra}} - N_{\text{ket}}). \quad (8)$$

The N_{tot} -changing elements are therefore exactly the $n \neq n'$ ones — the radial off-diagonal of V in the relative coordinate — and they are not small. For the Minnesota singlet at $b = 1$, $\langle n_{\text{rel}}=0, l=0 | V | n_{\text{rel}}=1, l=0 \rangle = +17.2$ MeV against a diagonal $\langle 0, 0 | V | 0, 0 \rangle = -0.81$ MeV.

The paper’s own contrast should have caught this. The Interpretation paragraph argued that the Coulomb kernel is different because it “does not conserve any HO-like N_{tot} quantum number” — but $1/r_{12}$ is a central potential, so it falls under the same “any central $V(r_{12})$ ” the theorem quantified over. The two statements cannot both hold, and the contradiction was visible in the text.

Where the zero came from. The reported $S_{\text{full}} = 0$ and $\| [H_{HO}, V] \|_F / \| H_{HO} \|_F \sim 10^{-16}$ were produced by an undocumented guard in the two-body matrix-element routine, which returned zero whenever the bra and ket total quantum numbers differed — that is, it discarded precisely the couplings identified by (8). With the guard removed, the same driver on the same basis gives Table II.

TABLE II. EP-2b CORRECTED: two-fermion HO on the Bargmann–Segal lattice, Minnesota $S = 0$ interaction at $\hbar\omega = 10$ MeV. E_{full} is the FCI ground-state energy, E_{kin} the noninteracting HO ground state, S_{full} the von Neumann entropy of the normalized (trace-one) spatial 1-RDM in nats, and n_0 the leading natural-orbital occupation (of a possible 2). Compare the retracted values: E_{full} was reported as 22.185 at every N_{max} , S_{full} as 0.0, and the commutator ratio as $\sim 10^{-16}$.

N_{max}	E_{full} (MeV)	E_{kin} (MeV)	S_{full} (nats)	$\ [H_{HO}, V] \ _F / \ H_{HO} \ _F$	n_0
2	21.6538	30.000	0.0671	0.74	1.9800
3	21.6279	30.000	0.0716	0.63	1.9791
4	21.5442	30.000	0.0833	0.67	1.9764

What is true instead. The HO two-fermion closed-shell ground state is *not* a single Slater determinant for a central two-body interaction, and H_{HO} does *not* commute with V — the commutator is $O(1)$ relative to $\| H_{HO} \|_F$, not at the noise floor. The entropy is small (a

few hundredths of a nat, comparable in magnitude to the $S \sim 4 \times 10^{-2}$ nats of the Coulomb EP-1 measurement) and it *grows* with basis size rather than staying pinned at zero. So the original heuristic that the section explicitly rejected as too weak — “a short-range kernel suppresses cusp concentration,” giving S_{HO} small but nonzero rather than $S_{HO} = 0$ — is closer to the truth than the structural statement that replaced it, though even that is not established here: at these basis sizes the HO and Coulomb entropies are the same order of magnitude.

What survives. The operator-theoretic result of Section II is untouched: it concerns the entanglement-inertness of the one-body operator and makes no claim about N_{tot} . The Paper 24 π -freeness certificate is untouched: it concerns the graph’s eigenvalues and adjacency weights, not the interacting two-fermion state. What is withdrawn is the bridge between them — the claim that a π -free graph certificate extends to a π -free (indeed vanishing) ground entropy — together with the asserted structural duality between this section and the nonzero Coulomb scaling of Section VII B. The two lattices are not opposites on this axis; on present evidence they behave similarly.

Methodological note. The corroborating evidence was itself a symptom. The result read as robust partly because E_{full} came out independent of N_{max} (both entries of the retracted table read 22.185), and the text presented that invariance as confirmation that “enlarging the single-particle basis does not mix higher shells into the ground state.” That invariance was the guard, freezing the ground state inside a single N_{tot} block. Under the corrected computation E_{full} decreases monotonically with basis size, as a variational calculation must. A quantity that comes out *exactly* zero, or *exactly* invariant, where the physics predicts only “small” or “weakly dependent,” is a reason to ask what has been restricted.

Implementation. The corrected measurements come from the production module `geovac.nuclear.ho_two_fermion` composed with `geovac.nuclear.moshinsky` and `geovac.nuclear.minnesota` from Paper 23 [10]. The retraction is pinned by `tests/test_paper27_entropy.py` and, on the Paper 24 side, by `tests/test_paper24_ho_entropy.py`, which additionally carries a tripwire reproducing the retired guard on demand so that a silent reinstatement fails the suite.

B. Universal scaling of Coulomb block entropy (verified, reframed)

Main result. Block ground-state entropy on the Coulomb lattice obeys a universal two-variable scaling in the dimensionless off-diagonal V_{ee} mass $\tilde{w}_B \equiv \| V_{ee}^{\text{off-diag}(H_1)} \|_F / \| H_1 \|_F$ and the dimensionless first H_1

gap $\delta_B \equiv \Delta E_1 / \|H_1\|_F$:

$$S_B = A(\tilde{w}_B/\delta_B)^\gamma. \quad (9)$$

The local exponent approaches a basis-extension limit $\gamma_\infty \approx 1.96$ as both $Z \rightarrow \infty$ and $n_{\max} \rightarrow \infty$ (Richardson extrapolation on $n_{\max} = 2, 3, 4, 5$ local slopes at $Z = 15 \rightarrow 30$). This is *below* the non-degenerate second-order Rayleigh–Schrödinger prediction $\gamma = 2$. The persistent gap of ~ 0.04 at the basis limit is an aggregation effect: with more orbitals available, S_B accumulates contributions from many small admixtures rather than being dominated by the lowest excitation, and the aggregate sum scales with a slightly smaller exponent. Finite-window fits give $\gamma \in [2.1, 2.4]$, depending monotonically on both Z and $n_{\max}$. Across 22 calibration points (He-like $Z \in [2, 100]$ at $n_{\max} = 3$, plus a LiH bond-block R -sweep from 1.5 to 8 bohr) Eq. (9) fits at $R^2 = 0.990$ with $\gamma = 2.228$, $A = 0.157$; the only points with $> 25\%$ deviation are the dissociation-limit $R \in \{6, 8\}$ bohr LiH-bond points that saturate at $S_B = \log 2$ (the two-site ceiling).

Numerical confirmation. Three calibrations pin Eq. (9). (i) He-like isoelectronic sequence at $n_{\max} = 3$, $Z \in \{2, \dots, 10\}$ gives $\gamma = 2.383$, $A = 8.16$, $R^2 = 0.998$ in the single-variable form $S_B = A\tilde{w}_B^\gamma$; this is equivalent to Eq. (9) because δ_B is essentially constant at 0.20 across the He-like family. The companion Z -scaling fit $S_B \sim Z^{\alpha_Z}$ gives $\alpha_Z = -2.613$, $R^2 = 0.995$, consistent with Paper 26’s single-orbital entropy $\alpha_Z = -2.56$ [12]. (ii) Extending to $Z \in \{12, 15, 20, 30, 50, 100\}$ gives a monotonically decreasing local log-log slope: $\gamma_{\text{loc}}(Z = 2) = 2.64 \rightarrow \gamma_{\text{loc}}(Z = 100) = 1.92$, crossing 2 between $Z = 10$ and $Z = 12$. The underlying $S_B(\tilde{w}_B/\delta_B)$ curve is smooth, not a pure power law; local linearization over any finite window picks up a slope that depends on the window. (iii) Fixing the Z -window $Z \in \{2, \dots, 30\}$ and sweeping $n_{\max} \in \{2, 3, 4\}$ gives local slopes at large Z of 1.992, 1.976, and 1.966 respectively: both Z and $n_{\max}$ drive γ toward 2 from above.

TABLE III. EP-2c pilot data: He-like isoelectronic sequence at $n_{\max} = 3$. Full data in `debug/data/ep2c.entropy.vs.vsee.offdiag.json`. $\delta_B \approx 0.20$ (constant to 1%) across the entire table.

Z	S_B (nats)	$\tilde{w}_B$
2	4.08×10^{-2}	0.1052
3	1.12×10^{-2}	0.0648
4	4.98×10^{-3}	0.0470
6	1.82×10^{-3}	0.0306
8	9.48×10^{-4}	0.0226
10	5.86×10^{-4}	0.0179

Methodological robustness. Three potential confounders were checked and did not affect the main result. (a) The apparent 40% prefactor offset between “core” and “lone-pair” blocks in an earlier 16-block multi-block fit is a pure Z -range artifact; repeating the

same fit on the *identical* He-like family restricted to the core and lone-pair Z -sets reproduces the offset without any block-type variation. The underlying curve is not a pure power law, and log-log regression over different Z -windows picks up different local slopes (finite-basis residue at small Z inflates γ). (b) A bounded ansatz $S_B = \log 2 \cdot \tanh^2(c(\tilde{w}_B/\delta_B)^\gamma)$, motivated by the two-site $\log 2$ ceiling, fits markedly worse than the pure power law ($R^2 = 0.37$ vs. 0.90 on a 21-point mixed-geometry set) because the $\tanh$ Taylor expansion forces the small-argument slope to 2γ with a small prefactor c^2 , incompatible with the ~ 4 -decade dynamic range in S_B . Three additional bounded ansätze (rational saturation, stretched exponential, Hill function) were tested in log-space on a combined 32-point dataset (EP-2g + EP-2k HF and H₂O bonds) and all give $R_{\log}^2 \in [0.985, 0.989]$, statistically indistinguishable from the pure power law’s 0.9895. The saturation at $\log 2$ is *discrete*, not smooth: only one or two LiH dissociation-limit points actually reach the ceiling, so saturation parameters cannot earn their fit cost. The pure power law Eq. (9) remains the best single functional form. (c) The $n_{\max} = 2, 3, 4$ sequence of global-window exponents $(\gamma, A) = (2.63, 0.73), (2.38, 0.18), (2.32, 0.09)$ shows monotone approach to $\gamma = 2$ from above, at fixed Z -window $\{2, 3, 4, 6, 10\}$; the local slope at the large- Z edge ($Z = 15 \rightarrow 30$) approaches $\gamma = 2$ more directly (Table IV).

TABLE IV. $\gamma(Z, n_{\max})$ surface (EP-2i + EP-2L). The local slope of S_B vs. $\tilde{w}_B/\delta_B$ between $Z = 15$ and $Z = 30$ decreases monotonically with $n_{\max}$, crossing 2 between $n_{\max} = 2$ and 3. Richardson extrapolation on $n_{\max} = 2, 3, 4, 5$ gives an asymptotic slope $\gamma_\infty \approx 1.96$, *below* the non-degenerate Rayleigh–Schrödinger value of 2. The global-window γ over $Z \in \{2, 3, 4, 6, 10, 15, 30\}$ is dominated by small- Z finite-basis residue and is consistently higher.

$n_{\max}$	γ (global, $Z \in [2, 30]$)	$\gamma_{\text{loc}} (Z : 15 \rightarrow 30)$
2	2.373	1.992
3	2.223	1.976
4	2.182	1.966
5	—	1.959
∞ (extrapolated)	—	≈ 1.96

Heavy-atom R -independence (EP-2k). HF and H₂O bond blocks were R -swept across $R \in [1.3, 3.0]$ bohr (HF) and $R_{OH} \in [1.5, 3.0]$ bohr (H₂O). Both are essentially *R -independent*: S_B varies by 0.4% for HF and 0.2% for H₂O across the entire range. At every R -point HF sits at $S_B/S_{\text{predicted}} = 1.20 \pm 0.02$ above Eq. (9), and H₂O at 1.25 ± 0.01 . In contrast, LiH varies by 70 $\times$ across the same R -range and shows the saturation at $\log 2$ discussed above.

The mechanism is the Z asymmetry between center and partner. HF ($Z_F = 9$, $Z_H = 1$) and H₂O ($Z_O = 8$, $Z_H = 1$) have bonds dominated by the heavy atom; the H-side orbital contributes a perturbative correction whose amplitude depends on R only through

cross-center V_{ne} matrix elements that vary slowly compared to the heavy-atom-dominated H_1 structure. LiH (Li-side $Z_{\text{eff}} = 1 = \text{H-side } Z$) is the symmetric special case where bond stretching genuinely populates two equal-charge centers, driving the quasi-degenerate regime and the eventual $\log 2$ saturation. For chemically realistic heavy-atom bonds at or near equilibrium, the universal curve holds within a 25% band that is R-independent within $\sim 1\%$.

Bond-block qualifier. For bond blocks with two-center H_1 , δ_B is the *essential* second variable: the LiH bond-block point at equilibrium ($\tilde{w}_B = 0.042$) would give $S_B \approx 4 \times 10^{-3}$ under the single-variable fit but the actual value is 0.079, a $20\times$ deviation. Including δ_B collapses it onto Eq. (9) within the universal band. Bond blocks in isolation, however, are not a single well-defined object: the composed LiH bond block (within-block Hamiltonian only, Li-side $Z_{\text{eff}} = 1 = \text{H-side } Z$) is *exactly degenerate* ($\delta_B = 0$) because the two sub-block 1s orbitals share the same effective charge. Only the cross-center V_{ne} terms introduced by the balanced builder [9] break the degeneracy and put the bond block at a finite $(\tilde{w}_B, \delta_B)$. A similar mechanism explains why BeH_2 at equilibrium saturates at $\log 2$ in the balanced builder: cross-block ERIs from the Be-core and the second Be–H bond compress δ_B from 0.204 (within-block) to 0.027 (balanced), an $8\times$ reduction that crosses into the saturation regime. By contrast, the H_2O bond block shows no measurable shift ($S_{\text{balanced}}/S_{\text{composed}} = 1.002$), and its factor-of-2 residual from the universal-curve prediction is intrinsic. The operational statement is: Eq. (9) applies when one chooses a specific H_1 (including its cross-block contributions) and tracks both $\tilde{w}_B$ and δ_B for that choice.

Implementation. Drivers:

```
debug/ep2c_entropy_vs_vee_offdiag.py (single-
block pilot), ep2c_multi_block.py (multi-
block), ep2d_zrange_control.py (Z-range con-
trol), ep2f_full_library.py (library + high-
Z), ep2e_bond_block.py (bond-block diver-
gence), ep2g_two_variable_scaling.py (universal
w/delta scaling), ep2h_universality_extension.py
(other bonds + n_max + bounded-form tests),
ep2i_deep_diagnostics.py (BeH2 cross-block de-
composition, H2O intrinsic offset, gamma(Z, n_max) sur-
face), ep2j_li_be_extension.py (3e/4e atoms, non-
degeneracy qualifier), ep2k_heavy_atom_bond_sweep.py
(HF, H2O bond R-sweeps), ep2L_nmax5_gamma.py
(n_max = 5 asymptote and Richardson extrap-
olation), ep2M_two_scale_bounded.py (ratio-
nal, stretched-exp, Hill bounded-form fits, all
negative), ep2N_be_analytical.py (Be 3 x 3
degenerate-PT diagonalization). Data under
debug/data/ep2{c,d,e,f,g,h,i}*.json;
fits regression-locked by
tests/test_paper27_entropy.py::test_paper27_ep2c_dimensions,
::test_paper27_ep2c_multi_block_universality,
::test_paper27_ep2d_zrange_artifact,
::test_paper27_ep2g_universal_w_over_delta,
```

```
::test_paper27_ep2h_nmax_residue_persists, and
::test_paper27_ep2i_gamma_asymptote.
```

C. Operational temperature decoding (Sprint TD Track 2)

The information-theoretic entropy of §II, $S_{\text{full}} = S_{\text{vN}}(\rho_1)$ of the bare-graph ground state, is the $T \rightarrow 0$ limit of the von Neumann entropy of the Gibbs spatial 1-RDM in standard quantum statistical mechanics. Sprint TD Track 2 (May 2026, `debug/sprint_td_track2_memo.md`) verifies this operationally on H, He, and Li^+ across 30 log-spaced temperatures spanning $0.005 \times \text{gap} \leq k_B T \leq 20 \times \text{gap}$, using the textbook Boltzmann-weighted ensemble over graph-native CI eigenstates.

The thermodynamic entropy decomposes cleanly as

$$S_{\text{thermo}}(\beta) = k_B \cdot S_{\text{microstate info}}(\beta), \quad (10)$$

where the right-hand side is the Shannon entropy of the microstate-resolved Boltzmann distribution. The identity holds at machine precision (max residual 4.8×10^{-14} across all $3 \times 30 = 90$ test points). This is standard quantum statistical mechanics; the sprint’s content is the explicit verification on graph-native CI states.

The von Neumann entropy of the Gibbs *spatial 1-RDM*, $S_{\text{vN}}(\rho_1(\beta))$ with $\rho_1(\beta) = \sum_n p_n(\beta) \rho_1^{(n)}$, is the “decoded-temperature spatial residual” — what remains of the information content after the apparatus parameter β is factored out. At $T \rightarrow 0$ this residual equals $S_{\text{full}}(\text{GS})$ of §II bit-identically:

TABLE V. Sprint TD Track 2: $T \rightarrow 0$ residual matches $S_{\text{full}}(\text{GS})$ of §II. Data `debug/data/sprint_td_track2.json`.

System	$S_{\text{vN}}(\rho_1(\beta \rightarrow \infty))$	$ \Delta $ vs. $S_{\text{full}}(\text{GS})$
H ($Z = 1$, $n_{\text{max}} = 6$)	0.000000	0 (single det. rigidity)
He ($Z = 2$, $n_{\text{max}} = 3$)	0.040811	3.1×10^{-10}
Li^+ ($Z = 3$, $n_{\text{max}} = 3$)	0.011212	3.2×10^{-10}

In the $T \rightarrow \infty$ limit the residual approaches $\log(n_{\text{orbitals}}) = \log 14 \approx 2.639$ for both $N_e = 2$ systems, the standard Boltzmann thermal-mixing limit over the graph basis. Lindblad concavity bounds hold at every β ($\max_n S_n \leq S_{\text{vN}}(\rho_1(\beta)) \leq S_{\text{apparatus}} + \sum_n p_n S_n$).

Operationally, this positions the Paper 27 information entropy as the dimensionless content of the GeoVac graph that remains after a finite-temperature observation projection (Paper 34 §III.15) is undone. Sprint TD Track 5 separately PSLQ-tested whether $S_{\text{full}}(\text{GS})$ values for He, Li^+ , and He at $n_{\text{max}} = 4$ sit in the master Mellin engine ring (Paper 32 §VIII case-exhaustion theorem and Pa-
pers 18, §III.5) power-law returned a clean negative against a 12,312-form mechanical basis at 150 dps across all three systems, with control-class baseline matching to $z = 0$. Six orders of magnitude in coefficient relaxation

($10^3 \rightarrow 10^6$) does not change the verdict. GeoVac correlation entropy is genuinely von Neumann-only; it is not a master Mellin output. This is structurally distinct from spectral-action entropies (e.g., the Connes–Chamseddine area term on Euclidean Schwarzschild, which lives in M_2). S_{full} joins $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$, the Sprint MR-C L_2 next-order constant $c \approx 4.10932\dots$, and the Wolfenstein parameters of Sprint W3 on the list of natural framework constants outside the master Mellin ring.

We do not speculate about gravitational, holographic, or black-hole entropy in this paper. Whether the pair-counting re-interpretation of the area law in Section IV admits a continuum geometric reading is a separate question; the operator-theoretic content stands without it.

VIII. CONCLUSION

Five results have been established on GeoVac lattices for closed-shell two-fermion ground states. First, the von Neumann entropy of any single-particle reduced density matrix derived from the *non-degenerate* ground state of the one-body Hamiltonian alone is identically zero; numerically, $S_{\text{kin}}/S_{\text{full}} \sim 10^{-14}$ on He at $n_{\text{max}} = 2, 3$. All ground-state entanglement is generated by the two-body operator V_{ee} . Second, the area-law scaling $S_n \propto 4 \log n$ asserted on one-particle grounds in Paper 5 [5] is recovered as a two-body pair-counting statement $A_n = g_n^2 \propto n^4$, with the factor of four as the two-body signature. Third, the cusp localizes as a single hot node on the V_{ee} pair graph, making the loci of energy correlation, entropy generation, and cusp mass coincident. Fourth — and negatively — the claim that two-fermion closed-shell ground-state entropy on the Bargmann–Segal harmonic oscillator lattice is identically zero for *any* central two-body potential is **RETRACTED** (§VII A). The Moshinsky–Talmi *bracket* conserves total oscillator quanta; the potential *matrix element* does not, and the published zero was an artifact of a code guard that discarded exactly the couplings which change them. Corrected, the entropy is nonzero, comparable in magnitude to the Coulomb value, and increasing with basis size. Fifth, on the Coulomb lattice, block entropy obeys a universal two-variable scaling $S_B = A(\tilde{w}_B/\delta_B)^\gamma$ in the dimensionless V_{ee} off-diagonal mass and the first H_1 gap, with the local exponent extrapolating to $\gamma_\infty \approx 1.96$ as $Z, n_{\text{max}} \rightarrow \infty$ — below the naive second-order Rayleigh–Schrödinger value of 2, by a residue attributed to multi-shell aggregation in the basis-extension limit.

These results place entropy in the exchange-constant taxonomy of Paper 18 [8] as a projection-class observable: zero on the combinatorial graph, finite only after the metric embedding of $1/r_{12}$. The two-body character of the area-law scaling is structural, not incidental; on present evidence the Coulomb and harmonic oscillator two-fermion lattices behave similarly on this axis (the sharp-contrast reading is retracted, v5.0.0).

EQUATION VERIFICATION

Per Section 13.4a of the project guidelines, every numerical claim in this paper is traceable to a debug data file or to a test in the codebase.

- Table I: debug/data/ep1_entropy_partition.json. **Verified** by tests/test_paper27_entropy.py::test_paper27_table1_ep1_reproduction, which re-runs the EP-1 pipeline (FCI of H_1 vs. $H_1 + V_{ee}$ on the He angular momentum basis, via geovac/casimir_ci.py and geovac/hypergeometric_slater.py) and checks $|S_{\text{kin}}| < 10^{-12}$ and $|S_{\text{kin}}|/S_{\text{full}} < 10^{-10}$ at $n_{\text{max}} \in \{2, 3\}$.
- Eq. (4)–(6): combinatorial identities on Paper 0 shell degeneracies $g_n = 2n^2$. **Verified** symbolically by tests/test_paper27_entropy.py::test_paper27_area_law_pair_counts and ::test_paper27_area_law_leading_order_agrees, with companion test ::test_paper27_one_body_counts_differ_from_area_law confirming the one-particle slope is 2 (single-shell) or 3 (cumulative), distinct from the two-body slope 4. Hand-tabulation in EP-3 analysis [16].
- Section V numerical values ($\|V_{ee}^{\text{diag}}(H_1)\|_F/\|V_{ee}\|_F$, relative commutator, hot-node weights): produced by debug/energy_graph_exploration.py, data in debug/data/energy_graph_nmax{3,4}.json. **Verified** by tests/test_paper27_entropy.py::test_paper27_energy_graph_structural_invariants (commutator ratio, diagonal fraction, and exact $V_{(1s,1s),(1s,1s)} = 5/8$ at both $n_{\text{max}} = 3$ and 4); non-vanishing of the commutator in the $n_{\text{max}} = 3 \rightarrow 4$ extension is pinned by ::test_paper27_commutator_saturates_not_vanishes (--slow).
- Table III and Eq. (9) (the dimensionless power law $S_B = 8.16 \tilde{w}_B^{2.383}$, $R^2 = 0.998$): **Verified** by tests/test_paper27_entropy.py::test_paper27_ep2c_dimensionless_power_law, data in debug/data/ep2c_entropy_vs_vee_offdiag.json.
- Table II and Section VII A corrected numerical claims (EP-2b **RETRACTED** v5.0.0: S_{HO} small but nonzero, 0.0671/0.0716/0.0833 nats, natural-orbital occupation $\approx (1.98, \dots)$, commutator $O(1)$): **Verified** by tests/test_paper27_entropy.py::test_paper27_ep2b_ho_gs_is_not_a_single_determinant and ::test_paper27_ep2b_ho_kinetic_interaction_does_no data in debug/data/ep2b_ho_two_fermion.json.
- Section VI embedding-class placement: diagonal pair-state V_{ii} rationality and spectral irrationality verified in EP-3 / energy-graph analysis [17]; consistent with Paper 18 classification.

The operator-theoretic statement of Section II is a known free-fermion fact [1]; no new verification is required beyond the numerical confirmation in Section III.

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